



BALKAN HOCKEY CHAMPIONSHIP

SEASON 2026 / 27 · SARAJEVO

SEASON 2026/27 · FIVE-TEAM FORMAT

Balkan Hockey Championship — an international championship with a centralised format: every game of the season is played at one arena in Sarajevo.

Teams: Belgrade · Sarajevo-1 · Sarajevo-2 · Bulgaria · a fifth team.

Regular season: 15 October 2026 — 8 January 2027. **Play-offs:** 9–10 January 2027.

HOW THE SEASON WORKS

Every pair of teams meets **three times**; every team plays **12 games**. The season totals 30 regular-season games plus 2 play-off games.

The season is not played in evenly spaced rounds but in **six events**. The reason is simple: travelling every month is expensive and hard on the players. Instead, visitors come rarely and play a lot while they are here.

EVENT TYPE	WHO TRAVELS	DAYS	GAMES
Block	Bulgaria for the whole block, Belgrade and the fifth team for the weekend	Thu – Sun	8
Guest weekend	Belgrade and the fifth team	Sat – Sun	3–5

Weekdays inside a block are played by the Sarajevo teams — no travel required. Weekends belong to the visitors. The two travelling clubs come together, so they play not only the hosts but each other as well.

No team ever plays two games back to back. Where a team plays twice in a day, another fixture always sits between its games, giving it a break of at least two and a half hours.

CALENDAR

Block 1 · 15–18 October 2026 — season opener

DAY	SLOT	GAME
Thu 15	18:00	Bulgaria – Sarajevo-1
Fri 16	18:00	Bulgaria – Sarajevo-2
Sat 17	15:00	Bulgaria – Belgrade
Sat 17	17:30	Sarajevo-1 – Sarajevo-2
Sat 17	20:00	Bulgaria – Team 5
Sun 18	11:00	Belgrade – Sarajevo-1
Sun 18	13:30	Team 5 – Sarajevo-2
Sun 18	16:00	Bulgaria – Belgrade

Guest weekend 1 · 31 October – 1 November 2026

DAY	SLOT	GAME
Sat 31	15:00	Belgrade – Team 5
Sat 31	17:30	Sarajevo-1 – Sarajevo-2
Sat 31	20:00	Belgrade – Team 5
Sun 1	11:00	Belgrade – Sarajevo-1
Sun 1	13:30	Team 5 – Sarajevo-2

Guest weekend 2 · 14–15 November 2026

DAY	SLOT	GAME
Sat 14	15:00	Team 5 – Sarajevo-1
Sat 14	17:30	Belgrade – Sarajevo-2
Sat 14	20:00	Team 5 – Sarajevo-1
Sun 15	11:00	Belgrade – Team 5

Guest weekend 3 · 28–29 November 2026

DAY	SLOT	GAME
Sat 28	16:00	Belgrade – Sarajevo-1
Sat 28	19:00	Team 5 – Sarajevo-2
Sun 29	11:00	Belgrade – Sarajevo-2

Block 2 · 10–13 December 2026

DAY	SLOT	GAME
Thu 10	18:00	Bulgaria – Sarajevo-1
Fri 11	18:00	Bulgaria – Sarajevo-2
Sat 12	15:00	Bulgaria – Team 5
Sat 12	17:30	Sarajevo-1 – Sarajevo-2
Sat 12	20:00	Bulgaria – Belgrade
Sun 13	11:00	Team 5 – Sarajevo-1
Sun 13	13:30	Belgrade – Sarajevo-2
Sun 13	16:00	Bulgaria – Team 5

Block 3 and Finals · 7–10 January 2027

DAY	SLOT	GAME
Thu 7	18:00	Bulgaria – Sarajevo-1
Fri 8	18:00	Bulgaria – Sarajevo-2
Sat 9	17:00	Semi-final: 2nd place – 3rd place
Sun 10	15:00	Final: 1st place – winner of the semi-final

HOW MUCH EACH TEAM PLAYS

TEAM	TRIPS	GAMES
Bulgaria	3 blocks	12
Belgrade	5 visits	12
Team 5	5 visits	12
Sarajevo-1	plays at home	12
Sarajevo-2	plays at home	12

Every pair of teams meets exactly three times — the table is fully symmetrical.

RULES AND PLAY-OFFS

- Games are played under the current **IIHF Official Rule Book**. Three periods of 20 minutes stop-time.
 - Points: regulation win 3, overtime or shootout win 2, overtime loss 1, regulation loss 0. There are no ties.
 - Standings are decided by **points percentage**, so an unequal number of games played during the season does not distort the table.
 - **Finals "Final 3"**: the top three teams reach the play-offs, the first goes straight to the final, the second and third meet in the semi-final. Fourth and fifth end their season in the regular schedule.
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COST OF PARTICIPATION

The fee is paid by the team as one flat sum for the season — it does not depend on the number of players. It covers ice for every game, officiating, organisation of match days, the secretariat and statistics, and basic video. The larger the roster, the cheaper participation becomes for each player. The exact figure for the five-team option is confirmed before the season starts.

Travel, accommodation, meals and equipment are paid by the team. Accommodation: partner hotel, **€40 per four-bed room** — €10 per person per night.

Balkan Hockey Championship · season 2026/27 · five-team option. Dates are provisional, subject to arena slots.